Reinforced panel prevents harness from puncturing vest during jump
Inflating toggle operates gas cartridge
Leg straps of cotton webbing
Clip
Pack strap clipped to webbing
Waistband
Carrier handles
Bungees spring open four corners of chute pack
Knuckle duster
D-ring release handle
Flap covering the returning mechanisim (for deploying chute)
Strap secured between legs
Camouflage sprayed on by hand
M1 bayonet scabbard
Knuckle duster attached to waist
Griswold bag
The M1 Garand rifle or the M1 Thompson was carried in the rifle bag. The rifle had to be broken down and the stock removed to fit in the bag. Troopers often carried side-arms so as not to be defenceless before they could assemble their primary weapon after landing. The M1 carbine, specific to the Airborne, had its own bag.
Musette bag
Attached to the front of the trooper's webbing during the jump, the bag was afterwards hung from the webbing on the back. It contained rations, spare clothing, ammunition, and any personal effects.
Type A4 emergency parachute
A version of the Army Airforce parachute modified for the Airborne, this was worn more for morale than anything, as below 300m (1000ft) the likelihood of deploying it in time if needed was minimal. After pulling the release handle the soldier would have to push the chute away from his body to unfurl it.
M1 bayonet knuckle duster
Unique to the 509th Battalion, this M1 bayonet has been customized to be a knuckle duster on the initiative of the owner.